

Question 2 - Vending Machine

I'm going with a standard snack and drink vending machine, the kind you'd find in office hallways or hospitals. It takes coins, notes and card taps. Anyone in hurry who wants a quick snack without dealing with a cashier

Walking through Experience:

1. What does the user want to achieve? just get the snack or drink they picked
2. What do they plan to do? Find the item's code and figure how they are paying
3. What action do they perform? Insert payment, then punch the item forward, with a beep and a light near the button
4. How does the machine respond? A motor or coil pushes the item forward, with a beep and a light near the button
5. What information is shown? Price, amount inserted, balance left, and error like exact change only

6. Can the user understand it? Mostly, but the lil display is often dim or uses shortened code that are hard to find read unless you're right in front of it
7. How do they know it worked? By hearing or seeing the item drop. if nothing falls and doesn't say why, you're left guessing whether to try again

Confusing or Frustrating Points

- items get stuck halfway down the coil very often
- After restock, the keypad codes sometimes don't work what is behind that slot anymore

Physical and Ergonomic Problems

- Small, closely spaced, low contrast keypad buttons that are easy to mis-press

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Two Improvements

1. Swap the keypad for a bigger touchscreen with large, high contrast text and ~~add~~ Photos of each item
2. Add a clear audio confirmation for each step
Payment received, dispensing, change returned